

SESSION 4 — CHANGE OF DIRECTION AND REACTION

60 minutes · agility bias · high nervous-system cost · needs eight cones, a flat 20 m area, a tape measure, a ball, ideally a partner

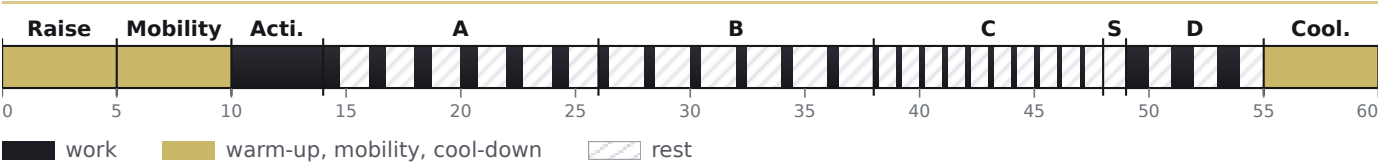
Session 3 trains how fast you can move. This one trains how fast you can stop and go the other way, and how quickly you start once someone else decides when. Fencing is almost entirely deceleration: the fencer who can stop hard out of a retreat is the one who can attack out of it.

Reaction work needs an external cue. Doing this session alone is possible — a random-number app or a bouncing ball will do — but it is the session most worth arranging a partner for.

Marker for the log: best 5-10-5 pro-agility time in block B, and which lead foot it was run from.

Stop rule: if you can no longer stop inside the coned gate on a hard stop, the block is finished. Overrunning the gate is a knee injury rehearsing itself.

Minute by minute



TIME	BLOCK	WORK AND REST
0:00-0:05	Raise	3 min jog, 2 min multi-directional · easy throughout
0:05-0:10	Mobility	Hips and adductors, five movements · easy throughout
0:10-0:14	Activation	Band, balance, slow skater hops · continuous work
0:14-0:26	A — Deceleration	6 rounds of 2 min · 45 s work / 75 s rest
0:26-0:38	B — Cut patterns	6 rounds of 2 min · 30 s work / 90 s rest
0:38-0:48	C — Reaction	10 rounds on the minute · 15 s work / 45 s rest
0:48-0:49	Setup	Move the cones for the distance game · rest
0:49-0:55	D — Fencing transfer	3 rounds of 2 min · 60 s work / 60 s rest
0:55-1:00	Cool-down	Hips, glutes, calves · easy throughout

0:00–0:05 · Raise

Easy throughout

Three minutes of easy jogging. Then two minutes of multi-directional work, 20 m of each: side shuffle leading left, side shuffle leading right, carioca each way, backpedal, and a jog-backpedal-jog transition.

0:05–0:10 · Mobility

Easy throughout

1. **Adductor rock**, 60 s. On hands and knees, one leg out to the side, rock back over the hips.
2. **90/90 hip switches**, 10 each way, slow, chest tall.
3. **Lateral lunge**, 10 each side, sitting into one hip with the other leg straight, foot flat.
4. **Ankle rock-overs**, 15 each side against the bench.
5. **Standing figure-4**, 30 s each side.

0:10–0:14 · Activation

Continuous work

- Band lateral walks, 10 steps each way, twice
- Single-leg balance, 30 s each leg, eyes closed
- Slow skater hops, 10 each side, sticking every landing for two seconds with the knee tracking over the middle of the foot, not caving inward

0:14–0:26 · Block A — Deceleration



6 × 45 s work / 75 s rest

Six rounds of two minutes. Set a cone as the start line and, 10 m away, two cones a meter apart as a gate, with a third cone a meter beyond it.

Three repetitions per round: build up over the 10 m to about 80% and stop dead between the gate and the far cone, absorbing through the hip and not the knee. Alternate which foot takes the final braking step. Then walk back and rest out the round.

Rounds 5 and 6: stop and immediately explode back the way you came.

Easier: shorten the run-up to 6 m and build to 60%. Harder: stop on a partner's call rather than at the box.

0:26–0:38 · Block B — Cut patterns



6 × 30 s work / 90 s rest

Six rounds of two minutes. Two repetitions per round, roughly 8–12 seconds each, then rest the remainder. One pattern per round; set the cones out before you start it.

ROUND	PATTERN
1	5-10-5 pro-agility — 5 m right, 10 m left, 5 m back. Time it. Both lead sides
2	L-drill: 5 m out, back, then around a cone at 5 m and return
3	T-drill: 10 m up, 5 m shuffle each way, backpedal home
4	Box drill: 5 m square — sprint, shuffle, backpedal, carioca
5	Zig-zag: five cones, 3 m apart, alternating sides, cutting off the outside foot
6	Figure-8 around two cones 5 m apart, two laps each direction

Time round 1 on a phone and log the better of the two runs. Everything else in this block is quality work, not a test.

0:38–0:48 • Block C — Reaction



10 × 15 s work / 45 s rest

Ten rounds of one minute: 15 seconds of work, 45 seconds of rest. Short, because the whole value is in being fresh enough to react rather than anticipate.

Rotate three drills:

- **Mirror drill** (rounds 1, 4, 7, 10). Face a partner two meters apart in en garde. One leads along a line, the other matches, holding distance exactly. Swap leader each round.
- **Called direction** (rounds 2, 5, 8). Partner calls or points; alone, use a random-number app beeping every 1.5 seconds with a number per direction.
- **Drop-ball chase** (rounds 3, 6, 9). Stand 4 m away in en garde. The partner drops a ball; catch it before the second bounce. Alone: bounce it hard off a wall and chase the rebound.

0:48–0:55 • Block D — Fencing transfer — the distance game



Rest

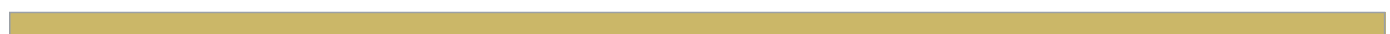
One minute to set up, then three rounds of two minutes: one minute of work, one minute of rest.

With a partner: both in en garde. One moves freely forward and back along the strip; the other holds exactly lunge distance, no closer, no further. Every 10 seconds or so the leader freezes, and the follower lunges — if the distance was right, the point lands on target; if not, it falls short or crashes in. Swap roles each round.

Alone: set a line of cones along the strip, the nearest one at your lunge distance from the post, move to a random-number call, and lunge to the post only when a call leaves your front foot at that nearest cone.

This block is where the whole session cashes out. Change of direction that does not serve distance control is just running around a park.

0:55–1:00 • Cool-down



Easy throughout

Two minutes of walking, then adductor stretch 45 s each side, figure-4 glute stretch 45 s each side, calf stretch 30 s each side. Finish with eight slow breaths, five in and eight out.

Log line

date · 04 change of direction · who · surface · 5-10-5 __ s (lead __) · box misses __ · felt
_/10

Kuou Fencing Club · internal training document · source: docs/park_workouts/04_change_of_direction.md